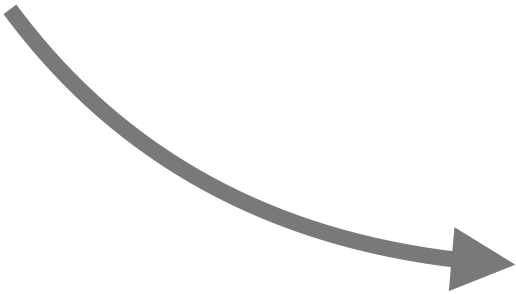


Now recall again the example of the geometry books. Leibniz's idea there seemed to be that, even if the existence of each geometry book in the (infinite) series could be explained by the one which preceded it, still the existence of the series as a whole cannot be explained by any geometry book in the series.

This seems plausible. It seems that if we want to explain why there are **any** things of a certain kind, this explanation can't be given in terms of some thing of that kind.

Suppose that we wanted to explain why rabbits exist in the universe. Our explanation could not begin like this: “Well, there were these two rabbits.

And then ...”





The fact that there are
contingent things is
contingent.

Every contingent fact
has an explanation.

The fact that there
are contingent things
has an explanation.



Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR



objections
to the
PSR

Now recall again the example of the geometry books. Leibniz's idea there seemed to be

explained by any geometry of k in the series.

by the one which preceded it, still the existence of the series as a whole can not be

that, even if the existence of each geometry in the (infinite) series could be explained

certain kind, this explanation can't be given in terms of something of that kind.

This seems plausible. It seems that if we want to explain why there are *any* things of a

Suppose that we wanted to explain why rabbits exist in the universe. Our



explanation could not begin like this: 'Well, there were these two rabbits



The fact that there are

containing things is

contingent.



Every continent has its

has an expiration.



are continuing to thrive

has an expiration.

The fact that there

... we cannot find in any of the individual things, or even in the entire collection and series of things, a sufficient reason for why they exist.

Let us suppose that a book on the elements of geometry has always existed, one copy always made from another. It is obvious that although we can explain a present copy of the book from the previous book from which it was copied, this will never lead us to a complete explanation, no matter how many books back we go, since we can always wonder why there have been such books.

What is true of these books is also true of the different states of the world ... however far back we might go into previous states, we will never find in those states a complete explanation for why there is a world at all, and why it is the way it is.



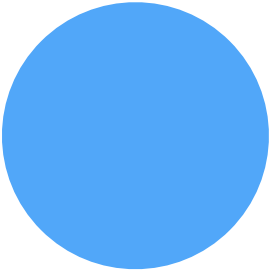
Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR

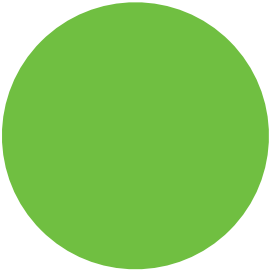


objections
to the
PSR









be Good.

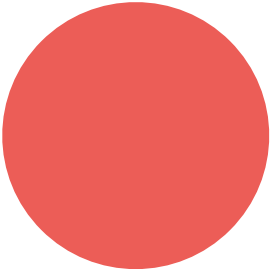
Last time we considered an objection to Aquinas' assumption that if a first

simply be some event, like the Big Bang, which is not a plausible candidate to

cause exists, then God exists: the objection was that the first cause could









The fact that there are
contingent things is
contingent.

Every contingent fact
has an explanation.

The fact that there
are contingent things
has an explanation.